

Questions

- Is there something you struggle with routinely or recently?
- Name something that you find frustrating or concerning about using digital technology?
- Is there something particular/specific you hope to learn from this course?

Session 1: Kick Off

Tech Skills 101: Driver's Ed for the Digital World

***Everyone* struggles!**

Common causes of problems

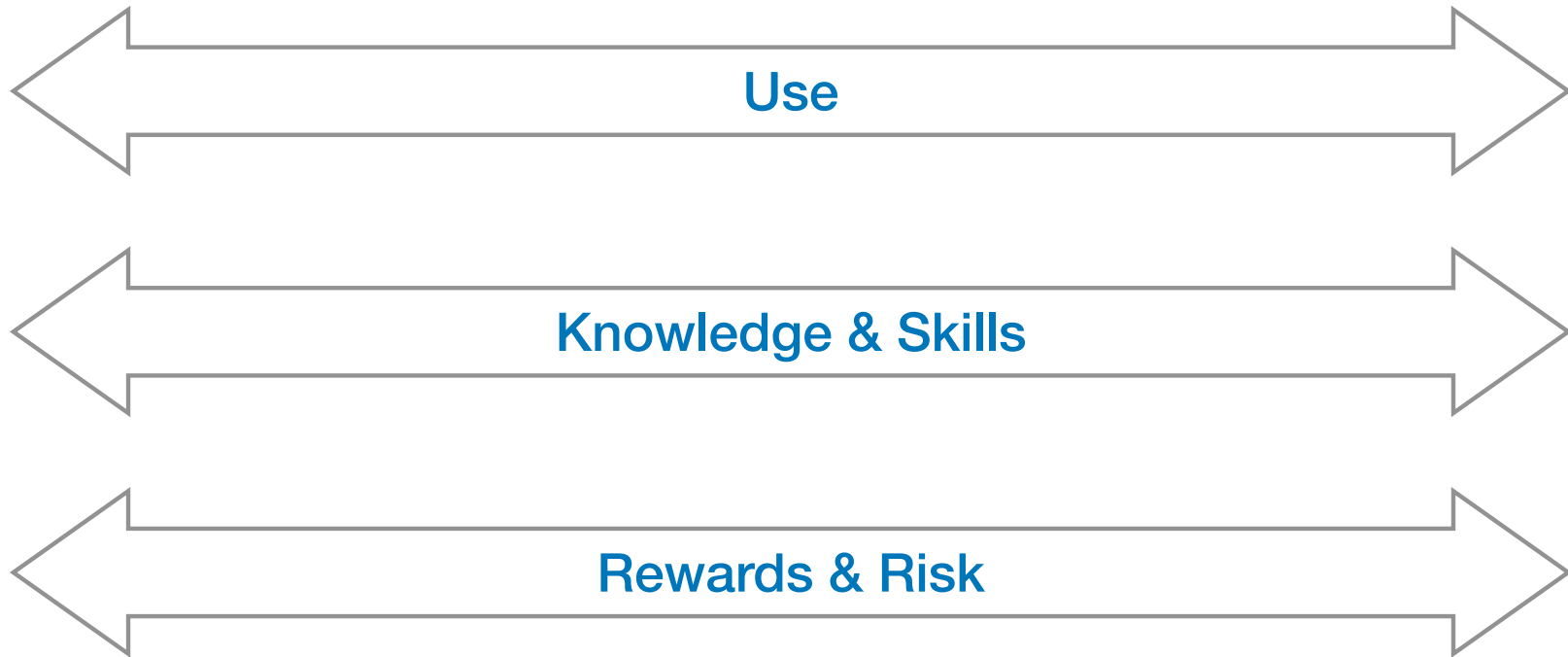
Note: It is fairly rare for a device to break / stop working entirely. When that does happen, the device typically does not work at all (ie, you can't turn it on/off; if the device is on, it will likely be "frozen").

- Your trying to do something you haven't done before
How you do that something isn't obvious/intuitive
- Something changed
- Ambiguous use of language
 - "Help" documentation/articles often use "insider" terms or assume the reader has certain *a priori* knowledge
 - "Borrowed" words vs "Made Up" words (and acronyms)
 - Apps can be non-intuitive
- You've encountered a "bug"

Definition of “HTTP” per britannica.com

HTTP, standard [application](#)-level [protocol](#) used for exchanging files on the [World Wide Web](#). HTTP runs on top of the [TCP/IP protocol](#) and (later) on the QUIC protocol. Web [browsers](#) are HTTP clients that send file requests to Web [servers](#), which in turn handle the requests via an HTTP service. HTTP was originally proposed in 1989 by [Tim Berners-Lee](#), who was a coauthor of the 1.0 specification. HTTP/1.0 (released in 1996) was “stateless”: each new request from a client established a new connection instead of handling all similar requests through the same connection between a specific client and [server](#). HTTP/1.1 (released in 1997) includes persistent connections, decompression of [HTML](#) files by client browsers, and multiple [domain names](#) sharing the same [IP address](#). HTTP/2 (released in 2015) was designed to solve problems with slow page loading and was a [binary](#) protocol in which binary values were used instead of plaintext as in previous versions. HTTP/3 relies on the faster QUIC protocol instead of TCP and, as of early 2022, was not yet released in final form but was supported by most browsers. In the 2010s many websites began using HTTPS (Secure HTTP), developed in 1994 by [Netscape Communications Corporation](#) and in which the SSL (Secure Sockets Layer) protocol was added to HTTP to provide a layer of encryption between browsers and servers.

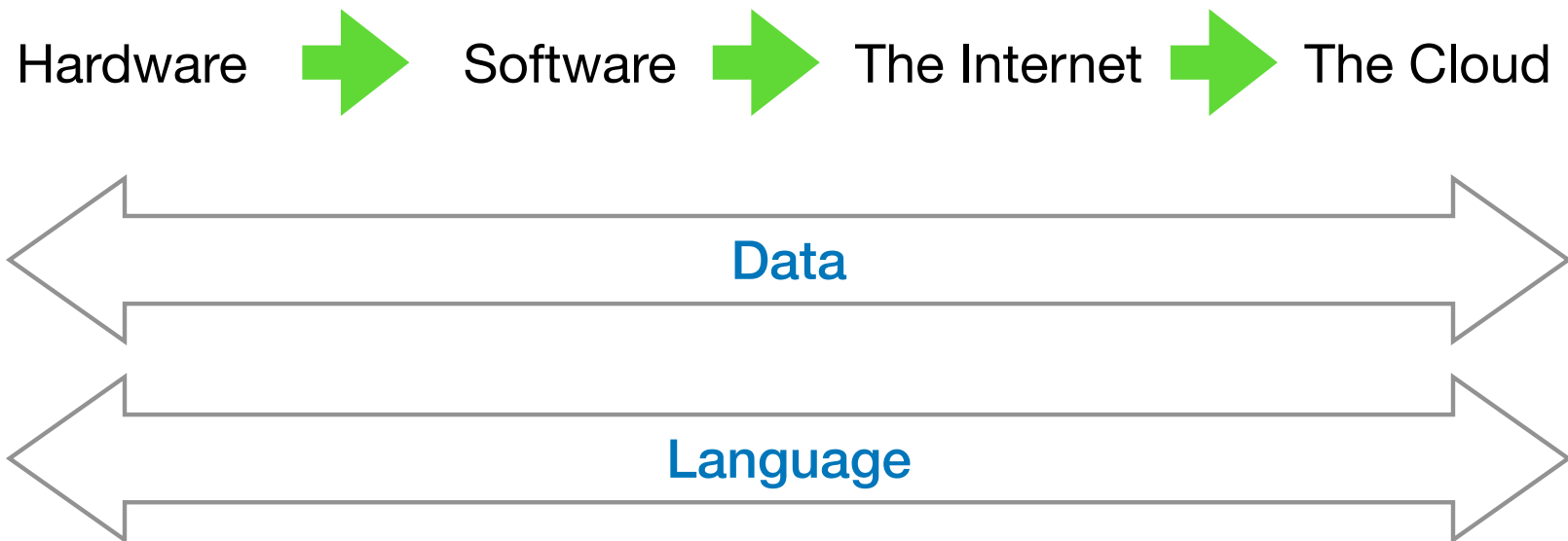
**Ask questions
and
Share your experiences**



Guiding Principles

- No one knows everything about digital technology
Focus on understanding how what you do most frequently and/or is most important to you works
- Digital devices are very sophisticated calculators (i.e., “under the covers” it’s all numbers and math)
- Software (apps & operating systems) are the “smarts”
- Digital technology changes/evolves fairly rapidly
Sometimes these changes are “forced on you” without your awareness
- Each of our digital lives is unique
 - We each (likely) do some different things with our digital devices
 - My device(s) are different than yours—even if we are using the same make/model
- There is often more than one way to complete a task/action
 - I.e., you usually have options; the best option for you may be different than the best option for me
- Software models the “analog” world
- Digital technology is nearly constantly changing
Staying “happy” involves some continuous learning
- Information vs data
- Digital technology has its own language

The “happy path”



Schedule

Sep 9	Kick Off
Sep 16	Devices: Part 1
Sep 23	<i>No class this week in observation of Rosh Hashanah</i>
Sep 30	Devices: Part 2
Oct 7	Apps: Part 1
Oct 14	Apps: Part 2
Oct 21	The Internet & the Web
Oct 28	The Cloud
Nov 4	Navigation <i>or</i> Safety & Privacy
Nov 11	Navigation <i>or</i> Safety & Privacy
Nov 18	Wrap Up

Summary of Key Points

- You are not stupid; everyone struggles
Staying proficient with digital technology is a continuing learning process
- In this course we will
 - discuss the basics of how hardware, software, the internet/web, and cloud work
 - discuss the language of digital technology
 - describe what digital data is and how it behaves
- Actively listen: ask questions; share challenges and concerns
- Schedule / syllabus